had been planted. It remains one of my regrets that I didn't turn to it immediately. The same day, my Australian bank card suddenly stopped working. I was being extra careful with mobile phones, only turning them on to receive messages, so the situation was particularly chaotic; but I put it out of my mind and got on with the Swedish tasks, which were towards establishing my editorial position there.

One evening I went to dinner with a few friends and their associates. The Swedish journalist Donald Böstrom, a friend and very experienced news man of about fifty, was there, along with another Swedish journalist and an American investigative journalist and his girlfriend. The American had possibly murky connections, but the girl was nice, and I was chatting her up with Donald frowning across from me. Donald later said I should watch what I was doing: he said the threat of a 'honeytrap' was high at that moment, and I remember he went into detail about how Mossad had captured Vanunu. I guess I must have been up for affection, to put it coyly, because I didn't think very seriously about what Donald was saying. I just made out like I knew how to take care of myself and felt I was so hyper-aware of security that the sort of thing he was describing could only happen to naive people who hadn't had the kind of experience I had. I wouldn't have to wait long to see how massively my hubris would backfire.

The parliamentary duty that had guaranteed me safe passage to Stockholm meant that I was under the care of a group of Social Democrats, many of whom had functions with other political groupings. I was told I'd be able to stay at the flat of a political worker called A——, who was away from her apartment. I went there, and after a few days she returned early. Ms A—— was a political spokesperson for the party and was involved in the arrangements to bring me over. I had no reason not to trust her, and no reason, when she pointed out that there was only one bed and would I be cool sleeping with her, to believe that this was naught but a friendly suggestion. I said yes, anyhow, and we went to bed together that night.

These political engagements are stressful and I was glad of the attention, when it came, of these smiling and affectionate women. It's embarrassing to say so, given that even a single man, as I was, is liable to be thought ungallant even for mentioning what went on with a woman in private. Or more than one woman. But the situation seemed not at all unusual and felt like part of something nice in an otherwise dark time. The Pentagon was calling for my head and many of my friends, and possibly sources, for all I